

I'm the guy that you have been sending letters to ... about our dog.... I have given your proposal some careful consideration.... I've decided I'm not going to get rid of my dog, nor am I going to sell my condominium.

This statement drew anticipated boos and hisses from the audience. After gaining the undivided attention of his targeted audience, he outlined his counterproposal: to turn his condominium unit over to his company's profit-sharing and pension plan and allow assembly-line employees to use the unit as a vacation resort fifty-two weeks a year. He asked his audience: "Would that be okay with all of you folks?"

Numerous members of the audience moaned. They were undoubtedly envisioning Mr. W.'s blue-collar employees invading their space fifty-two weeks a year! Some attendees shouted out, "Keep the dog, keep the dog!" The chairman of the action committee proposed that a committee meeting be held immediately in the adjoining conference room. Five minutes after this behind-closed-doors meeting, the committee members filed back into the room. The chairman told the audience of condominium owners that the action committee had made a decision.

"After reviewing all the elements of this situation, the action committee recommends that the W.s be allowed to keep their dog. I ask that the covenant be so amended. All in favor

Not long after this brilliant victory, the W.s sold their condominium unit. They did so because, as Mr. W. observed:

I don't want to live in a building with people who don't like dogs.

According to Mr. W., his dog was very important to him and his family. So much so that they sold the unit at a bargain price. They have sold other units in other complexes in which people were hostile to their dog. So how much is that doggie in the condominium worth? To the W.s, it's worth several hundreds of thousands of dollars. That's how much he estimates he lost in selling his units at below-true-market value. A hostile